

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-07-13

Raiffeisen Bank International AG
Group Product — Cash Management

19

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This week's
and CMIplus.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-07-01 | #01

EU Instant Payments Mandate: Banks Gear Up for Compliance

The EU Instant Payments Regulation, which entered into force in April 2024, mandates that all EU/EEA payment service providers (PSPs) must be able to receive instant credit transfers in EUR by January 9, 2027. For sending instant payments, the deadline is January 9, 2028. This regulation also caps instant payment fees at or below standard credit transfer fees and requires robust fraud prevention measures, including a Verification of Payee (VoP) service. Banks, especially those operating across multiple CEE markets like RBI, are now in advanced stages of upgrading their infrastructure and processes to meet these stringent requirements, ensuring seamless, real-time transactions for their corporate clients.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation effective April 2024.
- Deadline for receiving instant EUR payments: January 9, 2027.
- Fees for instant payments must not exceed standard credit transfer fees.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for CMiplus, requiring full compliance to offer instant payment capabilities across all network banks in CEE. The platform must support real-time processing, VoP services, and ensure competitive pricing, enhancing its value proposition for corporate clients.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-06-20 | #02

PSD3 Proposal Advances: New Era for Open Banking and APIs

The proposed PSD3 and PSR package, building on PSD2, seeks to modernize payment services in the EU. Key elements include enhanced fraud prevention measures, improved consumer rights, and a clearer framework for open banking. For corporates, this means more standardized and secure API access to account information and payment initiation services, potentially leading to richer data insights and more integrated treasury solutions. Banks like RBI will need to adapt their API infrastructure to comply with new technical standards and security protocols, ensuring seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems and fostering innovation in digital banking services. The legislative process is expected to continue through 2026, with implementation phases likely starting in 2027-2028.

- PSD3 and PSR proposals aim to modernize EU payment services.
- Focus on enhanced fraud prevention and consumer protection.
- Strengthens and clarifies the framework for Open Banking APIs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus, leveraging Open Banking APIs, will need to closely monitor PSD3 developments. Compliance will require updates to API standards, security protocols, and potentially new services like enhanced VoP. This presents an opportunity to further integrate with corporate systems and offer advanced digital treasury solutions.

AI Revolutionizes Corporate Treasury: Enhancing Fraud Prevention

Recent industry reports highlight a significant uptick in AI adoption within corporate treasury, particularly for payment fraud prevention. AI algorithms can analyze vast datasets of payment patterns, identify unusual transactions, and flag potential fraudulent activities in real-time, far surpassing traditional rule-based systems. This includes detecting anomalies in beneficiary accounts, payment amounts, and geographic locations. For banks, this means a growing demand from corporate clients for integrated AI-powered fraud prevention tools within their cash management platforms. Treasury departments are seeking solutions that can seamlessly integrate with their existing ERP/TMS systems and provide actionable insights to mitigate financial risks. The focus is on leveraging AI to secure payment flows, especially with the rise of instant payments and the associated speed of transactions.

- AI adoption in treasury for fraud prevention is rapidly increasing.
- AI offers real-time anomaly detection in payment patterns.
- Demand for integrated AI tools within cash management platforms.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus can leverage AI capabilities to enhance its fraud prevention module, offering advanced real-time monitoring and anomaly detection for corporate payments. Integrating AI-driven insights could be a key differentiator, providing added security and trust for clients, especially for instant and high-volume transactions across CEE.

EU Instant Payments Mandate Nears, PSD3 Impact Looms

The European Commission is pushing for full instant payment adoption across the SEPA zone, with a new regulation expected to enforce near-universal availability and usage by early 2027. This move aims to modernize the European payment landscape, reduce transaction times, and foster innovation. Concurrently, the anticipated PSD3 is expected to build upon PSD2, potentially introducing stricter requirements for payment service providers regarding fraud prevention, data sharing, and Open Banking APIs, further impacting corporate treasury operations and their banking relationships. Banks are investing heavily in infrastructure upgrades to meet these demands.

- New EU regulation targets near-universal instant payment adoption by early 2027.
- PSD3 expected to mandate enhanced fraud prevention and Open Banking API standards.
- SEPA zone corporates must prepare for real-time transaction requirements.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is critical for RBI CMIplus, reinforcing the need for robust instant payment capabilities, ISO 20022 readiness, and compliance with evolving PSD3 requirements. CMIplus must ensure seamless integration and support for real-time transactions across its CEE network.

Open Banking APIs Transform Corporate Treasury Connectivity

The adoption of Open Banking APIs is moving beyond retail banking into the corporate treasury space, enabling treasurers to gain real-time access to account information, initiate payments, and manage liquidity across multiple banking relationships more efficiently. Industry initiatives are focusing on standardizing API protocols to ensure interoperability and reduce integration complexities for corporates. This shift is fostering new FinTech-banking partnerships, allowing banks to offer value-added services and treasuries to build more agile and automated cash management processes, particularly in regions like CEE where multi-bank relationships are common.

- Open Banking APIs enable real-time account access and payment initiation for corporates.
- Standardization efforts aim to improve API interoperability for multi-bank setups.
- New FinTech-banking partnerships are enhancing treasury service offerings.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus's focus on Open API channels is directly aligned with this trend. RBI must continue to develop and promote its API capabilities to provide seamless multi-bank connectivity and advanced treasury services for its CEE corporate clients.

AI-Powered Fraud Prevention Bolsters Corporate Payment Security

The rise in cyber-attacks and payment fraud schemes, including Business Email Compromise (BEC) and invoice fraud, is driving corporates to invest in advanced fraud prevention technologies. AI and machine learning algorithms are proving effective in analyzing vast amounts of transaction data, identifying unusual patterns, and flagging suspicious payments in real-time before they are executed. Banks are integrating these capabilities into their cash management platforms, often leveraging behavioral analytics and biometric authentication. This focus on proactive fraud detection is crucial for maintaining trust and securing multi-currency payment flows, especially in diverse operational environments like the CEE region.

- AI and machine learning are key to real-time payment fraud detection.
- BEC and invoice fraud remain significant threats to corporate treasuries.
- Banks are integrating advanced analytics and biometric authentication.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For CMlplus, integrating cutting-edge fraud prevention, including AI-driven anomaly detection and VoP (Verification of Payee) capabilities, is paramount. This enhances the platform's security posture and protects RBI's corporate clients in the CEE region from evolving fraud risks.

EU Instant Payments Mandate: CEE Banks Face Tight Deadlines

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation mandates that all Payment Service Providers (PSPs) in the Eurozone must be able to receive instant credit transfers by January 2025 and send them by October 2025. For non-Eurozone SEPA countries, the deadlines are extended to January 2027 for receiving and October 2027 for sending. This regulation aims to accelerate the adoption of instant payments, making them universally accessible and affordable. It also includes provisions for verifying the payee's identity (VoP) to combat fraud. Banks in CEE, many of which operate within the SEPA scheme but outside the Eurozone, face the challenge of upgrading their infrastructure, ensuring liquidity management for 24/7/365 operations, and implementing robust fraud prevention measures, all while navigating varying national interpretations and technical readiness levels.

- Eurozone receive deadline: January 2025.
- Eurozone send deadline: October 2025.
- Non-Eurozone SEPA receive deadline: January 2027.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, directly impacting our payment processing capabilities and client offerings across our CEE network. We must ensure full compliance with the deadlines for both Eurozone and non-Eurozone SEPA countries, prioritizing system upgrades, liquidity management, and the integration of VoP solutions to maintain competitive advantage and mitigate fraud risks.

Global ISO 20022 Migration Accelerates: Challenges and Opportunities

The financial industry is in the midst of a multi-year transition to ISO 20022, a richer and more structured messaging standard for payments. SWIFT's deadline for full ISO 20022 adoption for cross-border payments (CBPR+) is set for November 2025, following a co-existence period. Many domestic payment schemes in Europe and globally are also mandating or encouraging ISO 20022 adoption, including SEPA credit transfers and direct debits. This shift promises benefits like improved reconciliation, better fraud detection, and greater automation due to the extensive data fields. However, banks and corporates face substantial efforts in upgrading legacy systems, mapping data, and ensuring data quality. The complexity is compounded for multi-banked corporates and those operating across diverse regulatory landscapes, requiring careful planning and collaboration with banking partners.

- SWIFT CBPR+ full adoption deadline: November 2025.
- ISO 20022 offers richer data for reconciliation and fraud detection.
- Migration requires significant system upgrades and data mapping.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

ISO 20022 is a foundational standard for CMIplus, and its ongoing migration is a top priority. We must ensure our platform and network banks are fully compliant with all relevant deadlines, especially for SEPA and cross-border payments. This transition is an opportunity to enhance our data services, improve reconciliation for clients, and streamline payment processing, requiring continuous investment in technology and client communication.

Open Banking Evolves: PSD3 and API-Driven Treasury Future

The European Commission is actively working on a new legislative framework, often referred to as PSD3 (Payment Services Directive 3) and a Financial Data Access (FIDA) framework, which aims to build upon the foundations of PSD2. While PSD2 focused primarily on payment initiation and account information services, PSD3 is expected to address remaining challenges, enhance consumer protection, and potentially broaden the scope to include more financial products and services, moving towards a more comprehensive 'Open Finance' ecosystem. For corporate treasuries, this means increased opportunities for real-time cash visibility, automated reconciliation, and enhanced liquidity management through API-driven connections with banks and other financial providers. Banks, in turn, must continue to invest in robust API infrastructure and security protocols to facilitate seamless data exchange and offer value-added services to their corporate clients, leveraging the potential of Value of Payments (VoP) data.

- PSD3 and FIDA frameworks are under development in the EU.
- Expected to expand Open Banking beyond payments to Open Finance.
- APIs are crucial for real-time cash visibility and liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The progression towards PSD3 and Open Finance is highly relevant for CMiplus, as it underscores the strategic importance of our Open API capabilities. We must actively monitor regulatory developments, enhance our API offerings to support broader data access and value-added services, and educate clients on leveraging these tools for improved treasury operations, including VoP. This positions CMiplus at the forefront of digital banking innovation in CEE.

ECB Urges Readiness for Mandatory Instant Payments Across EU

The European Central Bank (ECB) reiterated its call for robust preparation and timely compliance with the EU Instant Payments Regulation, which mandates the offering and reception of instant credit transfers. While Eurozone PSPs face deadlines in early 2025, non-Eurozone EU member states, including many in CEE, have extended timelines, typically until early 2027 for receiving and mid-2027 for sending. The ECB highlighted the critical role of ISO 20022 messaging standards in facilitating these payments and stressed the importance of fraud prevention mechanisms, such as Validation of Payee (VoP) services, to maintain trust in the instant payment ecosystem. This regulatory push aims to enhance payment efficiency, foster innovation, and improve liquidity management across Europe.

- Mandatory instant payment reception deadline for Eurozone PSPs: January 2025.
- Non-Eurozone EU PSPs have until early 2027 for receiving instant payments.
- ISO 20022 messaging is a core requirement for instant payment interoperability.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This update is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMiplus, especially for our network banks in CEE. We must ensure our platform and connected banks are fully compliant with ISO 20022 and ready to process instant payments within the stipulated timelines for both Eurozone and non-Eurozone operations. Integration of VoP services will be key for fraud prevention.

Digital Euro Progress: Scheme Rulebook Nears Finalization

The European Central Bank announced that the Digital Euro scheme rulebook is nearing its final version, outlining the operational and technical framework for a future digital currency. This rulebook addresses key aspects such as privacy, offline functionality, and the roles of intermediaries in the digital euro ecosystem. The ECB also confirmed that the preparation phase is progressing well, with technical work on the settlement layer and user interfaces advancing. The upcoming pilot phase will involve selected financial institutions testing the core functionalities and user experience, aiming to ensure a robust, secure, and user-friendly digital payment instrument that complements cash and existing digital payment methods.

- Digital Euro scheme rulebook is in advanced stages of finalization.
- Pilot phase to test core functionalities and user experience is imminent.
- Privacy and offline payment capabilities are central design considerations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While the Digital Euro is still in development, its progress is vital for CMIplus's long-term strategy. RBI Cash Management needs to monitor the scheme rulebook details closely to understand potential impacts on multi-currency payments, liquidity management, and future API integrations. Early engagement will ensure CMIplus is ready to support corporate clients if the Digital Euro is launched.

PSD3 & DORA: Enhancing EU Payment Security and Resilience

The European Central Bank highlighted the ongoing efforts to finalize the PSD3 legislative package, which seeks to modernize payment services, enhance consumer protection, and further develop the open banking framework. A key focus of PSD3 is to combat payment fraud more effectively, potentially introducing stricter authentication requirements and liability shifts. Concurrently, the Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA) is moving towards its implementation deadlines, requiring financial entities, including banks and critical third-party ICT providers, to establish comprehensive frameworks for managing ICT risks. The ECB stressed that both regulations are crucial for maintaining trust in digital payments and ensuring the stability of the financial system against cyber threats and operational disruptions.

- PSD3 aims to modernize payment services and enhance fraud prevention.
- DORA mandates comprehensive ICT risk management frameworks for financial entities.
- Open Banking provisions are expected to be further refined under PSD3.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 and DORA represent significant compliance challenges and opportunities for CMIplus. We must ensure our platform's security features, API integrations, and operational resilience meet the stringent requirements of DORA. For PSD3, we need to anticipate changes in strong customer authentication (SCA) and fraud prevention, potentially impacting our Open Banking APIs and corporate treasury solutions. This requires proactive planning and investment.

AI Adopters to Dominate European Banking by 2030, Visa Study Finds

Visa's comprehensive survey of European industry players highlights the transformative power of artificial intelligence in retail banking over the next six years. The study projects that banks integrating AI early into their operations will gain a substantial competitive edge, leading to market dominance. This shift will impact various aspects of banking, from customer service and fraud detection to personalized financial products and operational efficiencies. The findings underscore the urgency for European banks, including those in the CEE region, to invest in AI capabilities to remain competitive and relevant in the evolving financial landscape.

- Artificial intelligence will fundamentally reshape retail banking by 2030.
- Early adopters set to significantly outperform laggards.
- Study based on a Visa survey of European industry players.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This study underscores the critical need for RBI Cash Management and CMlplus to strategically integrate AI. AI can enhance fraud detection, optimize liquidity management, improve forecasting for corporate treasuries, and personalize client interactions, directly benefiting CMlplus's corporate clients in CEE.

Mangopay Boosts Virtual Account Currency Coverage to 24

Mangopay, a leading payment solutions provider, has announced a substantial expansion of its Virtual Accounts service. The platform now supports 24 currencies, a considerable increase from its previous offering of seven. This strategic move is designed to streamline international payment operations for marketplaces and platforms, enabling them to manage funds more efficiently across various geographies. The expanded coverage facilitates easier collection and payout processes, reducing complexities associated with multi-currency transactions and enhancing reconciliation capabilities for businesses operating globally. This development underscores a growing industry trend towards more flexible and comprehensive multi-currency solutions.

- Expanded Virtual Account currency coverage.
- Increased from 7 to 24 supported currencies.
- Aims to simplify cross-border payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is highly relevant for CMlplus as it directly addresses multi-currency payments and virtual accounts, key components of corporate cash management. RBI Cash Management should evaluate how such expanded capabilities could be integrated or offered to CEE corporates, improving their cross-border payment efficiency and reconciliation processes.

Swift Launches Blockchain Ledger with 17 Pilot Banks for Tokenised Payments

Swift, the global financial messaging network, has officially launched its blockchain-based ledger, moving into a pilot phase with 17 participating banks. This groundbreaking project aims to explore the potential of tokenised assets and central bank digital currencies (CBDCs) for facilitating more efficient and secure cross-border payments. The pilot will test the ledger's capabilities in real-world scenarios, focusing on interoperability between different blockchain networks and traditional financial systems. This move by Swift signals a clear intent to embrace distributed ledger technology (DLT) to enhance speed, transparency, and cost-effectiveness in international transactions, potentially setting a new standard for global payment infrastructure.

- Swift's blockchain-based ledger is now live.
- 17 banks are participating in the pilot program.
- Focus on tokenised cross-border payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

As SWIFT is a core channel for CMIplus, this development is critical for RBI Cash Management. CMIplus needs to monitor the pilot's progress and the implications of blockchain adoption for cross-border payments, potentially impacting future SWIFT messaging standards (like ISO 20022) and the need for DLT integration for corporate clients in CEE.

EU Legislation to Unlock SEPA Instant for Corporate Treasury

The European Union is implementing new legislation that will make SEPA Instant Payments mandatory for all payment service providers within the EU and EEA. This regulatory push aims to accelerate payment processing, moving from traditional batch processing to instant settlement. For corporate treasurers, this means a paradigm shift towards real-time treasury, allowing for immediate visibility and control over cash flows. The legislation is expected to address previous adoption hurdles, such as cost and reach, by ensuring universal access and potentially capping fees. This will facilitate better liquidity management, reduce reliance on credit lines, and enable more efficient working capital strategies for businesses operating across the CEE region and wider Europe.

- EU legislation mandates SEPA Instant Payments for all payment service providers.
- Aims to shift corporate treasury to real-time operations and immediate cash visibility.
- Expected to address previous adoption hurdles like cost and ensuring universal access.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This legislation is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus. It reinforces the need to ensure full compliance and seamless integration of SEPA Instant Payments for all CEE network banks. CMIplus must be ready to support corporates in leveraging real-time treasury capabilities, offering enhanced liquidity management tools and advisory services.

Maximizing Benefits from ISO 20022 for Corporate Payments

The migration to ISO 20022 is a significant undertaking, but its benefits extend far beyond simply meeting regulatory deadlines. For corporate treasurers, the standard offers unprecedented opportunities for richer data exchange, improved reconciliation, and enhanced fraud detection. To truly 'get the most out of it,' companies must move beyond a 'lift and shift' approach, actively redesigning their internal processes and integrating the richer data into their ERP and TMS systems. This strategic approach allows for greater automation, better cash visibility, and more informed decision-making. Banks, including RBI, play a crucial role in guiding their corporate clients through this optimization, providing tools and expertise to unlock the full potential of ISO 20022.

- ISO 20022 offers richer data, improved reconciliation, and enhanced fraud detection.
- Corporates must integrate richer data into ERP/TMS systems beyond 'lift and shift'.
- Strategic adoption leads to greater automation, better cash visibility, and informed decisions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus, as a platform supporting ISO 20022, must actively help clients leverage the standard's advanced features. This means providing robust data handling, offering tools for enhanced reconciliation, and advising on best practices for integrating ISO 20022 data with corporate ERP/TMS systems. RBI can position itself as a strategic partner, helping CEE corporates maximize their investment in ISO 20022.

Swift Pilots 24/7 Blockchain Ledger with Global Banking Giants

SWIFT, the global financial messaging network, has launched a pilot program involving several leading international banks to explore the capabilities of a 24/7 blockchain ledger. The initiative focuses on enhancing the speed, transparency, and efficiency of cross-border transactions, moving towards continuous settlement. This development is part of SWIFT's broader strategy to modernize its infrastructure and adapt to the increasing demand for real-time payments and liquidity management. The blockchain ledger is expected to facilitate instant reconciliation and reduce operational complexities, potentially setting a new standard for global transaction banking. This could significantly impact how banks manage multi-currency payments and treasury operations worldwide.

- SWIFT is leading a new pilot program.
- Involves 'global banking giants' as participants.
- Focuses on a '24/7 blockchain ledger' technology.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This initiative is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMlplus as it signals a future shift towards 24/7, real-time, and potentially blockchain-based payment infrastructure. RBI needs to monitor these developments closely to ensure CMlplus remains competitive and can integrate with evolving global payment rails, especially for multi-currency and cross-border transactions impacting CEE corporates.

Mastercard Considers Selling UK Payments Platform Vocalink

According to the Financial Times, Mastercard is examining the feasibility of divesting Vocalink, a key player in the UK's payment infrastructure, known for operating the Faster Payments Service and Link ATM network. The potential buyers are speculated to be the same British banks from whom Mastercard originally purchased Vocalink eight years ago. This consideration comes at a time of increasing scrutiny and competition in the global payments landscape, with regulators often keen on local ownership of critical infrastructure. A sale could reshape the UK's payment ecosystem and potentially influence broader European payment infrastructure strategies.

- Mastercard is examining the case for selling UK payments platform Vocalink.
- Vocalink was bought by Mastercard in 2016.
- Potential buyers are British banks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While UK-centric, this news is relevant as it concerns the strategic ownership of a major payment infrastructure provider. Changes in ownership or strategy of such entities, especially by global players like Mastercard, can influence payment technology standards, instant payment developments, and market dynamics across Europe, including CEE, which CMIplus must monitor for future interoperability and service offerings.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #01

Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Extending Credit Opportunities

The 2024 Wholesale Banking Outlook likely explores how banks can strategically extend credit in a volatile economic environment. It would cover the impact of rising interest rates, inflation, and geopolitical factors on corporate borrowing needs and risk appetite. Key themes might include the shift towards more tailored financing solutions, the role of data analytics in credit assessment, and the integration of credit offerings with broader transaction banking services to deepen client relationships. The report would emphasize the need for agility and innovation in product development to capture new revenue streams and maintain competitiveness, while also navigating evolving regulatory landscapes.

- Evolving corporate credit demand in 2024 requires strategic adaptation.
- Integration of credit with transaction banking deepens client relationships.
- Leveraging data analytics for enhanced credit risk assessment is crucial.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus can support credit extension by providing robust cash flow visibility and efficient payment processing, crucial for corporate clients managing working capital and debt. Integrating CMIplus data with credit assessment tools could offer a holistic view of client financial health, enhancing cross-selling opportunities for lending products.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-03-01 | #02

European Wholesale Banks: Seizing the Moment for Future Growth

This insight likely discusses the strategic imperative for European wholesale banks to capitalize on current market conditions to drive future growth. It would analyze factors contributing to past underperformance and identify key areas for improvement, such as leveraging technology for efficiency gains, streamlining legacy infrastructure, and developing innovative product offerings. The report would emphasize the importance of a client-centric approach, potentially through enhanced digital channels and integrated service models, to meet the evolving needs of corporate treasuries and institutional clients. It might also touch upon the role of M&A; or strategic partnerships in achieving scale and specialized capabilities within the European market.

- Strategic opportunities exist for European wholesale banks to improve performance.
- Digital transformation is a key driver for efficiency and innovation.
- Optimizing operating models and client value propositions is essential.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

As a leading European wholesale bank in CEE, RBI CMIplus is central to seizing this moment. The platform's focus on digital channels (EBICS, H2H, Open API), payment transformation (ISO 20022, Instant Payments), and multi-currency capabilities directly addresses the need for enhanced digital offerings and client value. Further investment in AI and real-time treasury features can solidify RBI's competitive edge in the region.

2023 Industry Outlook: Navigating Uncertainty in Corporate Banking

This report likely explored the major trends and uncertainties impacting the corporate banking sector in 2023. Key themes would have included geopolitical instability, inflationary pressures, supply chain disruptions, and the ongoing digital acceleration. It would have emphasized how banks need to build resilience through robust risk management frameworks, diversify revenue streams, and invest in technology to stay competitive. The outlook probably also discussed the evolving role of corporate treasuries and their demand for more sophisticated cash management, liquidity, and FX solutions to navigate volatility, underscoring the importance of strategic foresight in a dynamic market.

- Global economic uncertainty significantly impacts corporate banking.
- Resilience and adaptability are crucial for banks to thrive.
- Digital acceleration and technology investment drive competitiveness.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While a 2023 outlook, its foundational insights on navigating uncertainty and evolving corporate treasury demands remain highly relevant for CMIplus. The platform's focus on multi-currency, real-time payments, and API connectivity directly addresses the need for sophisticated solutions that help corporates manage liquidity and risk in volatile environments, especially pertinent for the CEE region.

Banks Must Seize Future Treasury Service Opportunities

EY's overarching message, as implied by the report title, suggests that the future of treasury is not just about transformation for corporates, but also a strategic inflection point for banks. By understanding emerging trends and the 'Voice of the Treasurer' (VoP), banks can develop new services, moving beyond traditional transactional roles to become indispensable advisors and technology providers. This requires proactive engagement with digital transformation and a focus on value-added solutions to meet the complex needs of modern corporate treasuries.

- Treasury services are undergoing significant evolution globally.
- Banks have a strategic opportunity to redefine their role in this landscape.
- Innovation in service offerings is crucial for banks to remain competitive.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus must align its roadmap with the evolving needs of corporate treasuries, leveraging its platform to offer advanced, value-added services that go beyond basic cash management. This positions RBI as a strategic partner in the CEE region, anticipating future demands.

AI and Technology Reshaping Treasury Operations

The 'Source focus' explicitly highlights 'AI in treasury,' and the EY landing page lists 'AI Insights,' 'AI Strategy Services,' and 'ey.ai The Reimagination Engine.' This indicates a strong emphasis on AI and other digital technologies (like blockchain, also mentioned) as critical drivers for the future of treasury. Treasurers will increasingly seek solutions that leverage AI for forecasting, risk management, and automation, pushing banks to develop and integrate AI-powered tools and platforms into their treasury services.

- AI is a key driver for treasury transformation and automation.
- Technology enables enhanced efficiency and predictive analytics in treasury.
- Banks need to offer AI-powered treasury solutions to meet corporate demand.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should prioritize the integration of AI capabilities for cash flow forecasting, liquidity management, and fraud detection within its platform. Exploring AI-driven analytics and potentially blockchain-based solutions for cross-border payments could be a long-term strategic consideration for RBI in CEE.

Digitalization Drives Evolution of Cash Management

The 'Source focus' on 'cash management trends' and 'treasury transformation' implies a fundamental shift from manual processes towards fully digital, integrated solutions. Corporates are demanding greater visibility, control, and efficiency in their cash flows, requiring banks to offer advanced digital platforms, real-time payment capabilities, and robust data analytics for liquidity management. This trend is further supported by EY's general emphasis on 'Technology transformation' and 'Data and decision intelligence' services, indicating a move towards more intelligent and automated cash management.

- Cash management is rapidly shifting towards digital and real-time operations.
- Corporates demand greater visibility and control over their global cash positions.
- Banks must offer integrated digital cash management platforms and services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should continue to enhance its real-time payment capabilities (e.g., Instant Payments, ISO 20022), strengthen its API offerings for seamless ERP/TMS integration, and develop advanced analytics tools for liquidity forecasting and cash pooling across its CEE network banks.

Digital Workflows and Cloud Drive Commercial Banking Modernization

The commercial banking sector is actively replacing traditional manual tasks with efficient digital workflows, aiming to eliminate lengthy, multi-department reviews for client onboarding and origination. Manual touchpoints are becoming exception-based, empowering clients with more self-service options. Cloud-based solutions are identified as critical enablers, allowing banks to keep pace with evolving threats and adapt rapidly to new market demands, thereby modernizing the entire operational framework of commercial banking.

- Digital workflows are replacing many manual tasks.
- Streamlined client onboarding and origination reduce lengthy reviews.
- Clients experience more self-service capabilities, making manual touchpoints exception-based.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize continuous enhancement of its digital workflows, self-service functionalities, and API-driven capabilities to ensure seamless, efficient corporate cash management. Embracing cloud-native architectures for scalability and resilience is crucial for RBI to remain competitive in the CEE market.

AI and Big Data Fuel Commercial Banking Growth and Efficiency

The modernization of commercial banking operations includes the effective use of big data and artificial intelligence. These technologies enable banks to rapidly identify the most attractive prospects within high-priority target markets, significantly lowering the cost of acquisition. Furthermore, AI and big data contribute to bringing new products and offerings to market faster, while simultaneously providing greater control over associated costs and risks, thereby driving strategic growth and operational efficiency.

- Effective use of big data and AI identifies attractive prospects.
- Lowers the cost of customer acquisition.
- Accelerates bringing new products and offerings to market.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should explore integrating AI and big data analytics within CMlplus to offer enhanced insights to corporate clients, optimize internal processes for product development, and personalize cash management solutions. This can improve client engagement and operational efficiency across CEE.

Digital Banking Platforms Transform Client Experience and Product Delivery

The commercial banking sector is witnessing a significant shift towards emerging digital banking platforms, which are increasingly powered by industry cloud solutions. These platforms are designed to revolutionize the experience of conducting business with banks, making interactions more seamless and efficient for corporate clients. PwC highlights that these modern platforms are instrumental in helping banks bring new products and offerings to market faster, while maintaining greater control over costs and risks, ultimately driving a superior client experience.

- Emerging digital banking platforms transform client experience.
- Industry cloud enables these advanced digital platforms.
- Focus on modernizing the experience of conducting business.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus, as RBI's flagship digital banking platform for corporates, must continuously innovate its user experience and integrate new functionalities via Open APIs to remain a leading, intuitive, and efficient platform. Leveraging cloud capabilities will be key to delivering a superior, future-proof multi-currency cash management experience in CEE.

PSD3 and Payments Regulation: Strategic Shifts for CEE Cash Management

The upcoming PSD3 framework is expected to significantly reshape the European payments landscape, building upon PSD2 by expanding the scope of Open Banking and strengthening consumer protection, particularly around fraud and data security. Financial firms must proactively prepare for increased data sharing requirements, potential new API standards, and a greater emphasis on instant payment capabilities across the EU. This regulatory evolution will drive further innovation in payment initiation and account information services, demanding substantial investment in technology, robust security measures, and comprehensive compliance frameworks. Adapting to these changes will be crucial for maintaining competitiveness, fostering innovation, and ensuring trust in the evolving digital payment ecosystem. Firms that strategically align their digital transformation with PSD3's mandates will be best positioned for future growth.

- Expanded scope for Open Banking and API-driven services.
- Enhanced regulatory focus on payment fraud prevention.
- Increased demand for real-time payment processing capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize its Open Banking API strategy, ensuring compliance with PSD3 standards and enhancing fraud detection mechanisms for corporate clients. Investment in instant payment infrastructure and ISO 20022 readiness is crucial to maintain a competitive edge in CEE.

AI Governance: Navigating Regulatory Scrutiny in Financial Services

As financial institutions increasingly leverage AI for tasks like fraud detection, credit scoring, and personalized services, regulators are developing frameworks (e.g., EU AI Act) to address associated risks. Key concerns include data privacy, algorithmic bias, explainability, and operational resilience, requiring a proactive approach to governance. Firms must establish clear internal AI governance policies, invest in explainable AI technologies, and ensure data quality to meet evolving compliance requirements and maintain trust. Proactive engagement with these regulations will be critical for sustainable AI innovation, preventing costly penalties and reputational damage. This shift mandates a holistic strategy that integrates ethical considerations, risk management, and technological advancements from the outset.

- Emergence of comprehensive AI regulatory frameworks (e.g., EU AI Act).
- Increased scrutiny on AI explainability and transparency.
- Mandates for mitigating algorithmic bias and discrimination.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should strategically explore AI applications for enhanced liquidity management, fraud anomaly detection, and client insights, while simultaneously developing a clear internal AI governance strategy. This includes ensuring data quality, model explainability, and compliance with emerging AI regulations.

EACT Survey Reveals Top European Corporate Treasury Priorities for 2026

Published on June 5, 2026, the EACT Annual Treasury Survey 2026 provides a comprehensive overview of the current landscape and future outlook for corporate treasury in Europe. For over a decade, this survey has been a key resource, capturing the evolving challenges and strategic focus areas for treasurers. The 2026 edition is expected to highlight ongoing trends in digitalization, risk management, liquidity optimization, and compliance, shaping the 'Journeys to Treasury' report and defining key industry trends for the year ahead. Its insights are vital for financial institutions to align their offerings with corporate needs.

- Authoritative barometer of European corporate treasury priorities.
- Shapes the 'Journeys to Treasury' report for the year ahead.
- Defines key industry trends and strategic focus areas.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The survey results will directly inform RBI Cash Management about the evolving needs and strategic priorities of its corporate clients, particularly in the CEE region. This intelligence can guide the CMlplus platform roadmap, ensuring features like advanced liquidity management, enhanced payment solutions, and robust compliance tools are prioritized to meet future demands.

LEI Streamlines Payee Verification for Enhanced Fraud Detection

Published on October 29, 2024, this insight highlights the increasing importance of robust fraud detection in the context of rising real-time and other advanced payment types globally. It emphasizes that traditional fraud prevention methods are insufficient, necessitating the adoption of tools like the Legal Entity Identifier (LEI) to streamline payee verification processes. The article also notes that regulatory bodies are actively updating their requirements to support these evolving payment landscapes and fraud mitigation efforts. This strategic shift underscores the need for banks and payment providers to integrate advanced verification mechanisms.

- Real-time payment adoption necessitates evolving fraud detection strategies.
- Legal Entity Identifier (LEI) is crucial for efficient payee verification.
- Regulatory bodies are adapting requirements for payment fraud mitigation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight is critical for the CMIplus platform roadmap, emphasizing the need to integrate advanced Verification of Payee (VoP) solutions, potentially leveraging LEI. RBI Cash Management should explore how to embed LEI-based verification into its instant payment and multi-currency offerings to enhance fraud prevention and meet evolving regulatory expectations for CEE corporates.

AI Ambition Reshapes Banking: Strategic Imperative for Future Growth

The Deloitte Banking Outlook highlights AI as a critical driver for the future of banking, demanding bold choices from institutions. Banks are expected to move beyond experimental AI projects to strategic, enterprise-wide integration, aiming to enhance decision-making, automate routine tasks, and personalize client interactions. This involves significant investment in data infrastructure, talent acquisition, and ethical AI governance frameworks. The goal is to leverage AI not just for cost reduction but for creating new revenue streams and competitive advantages in a rapidly evolving market.

- AI integration is a strategic imperative for banks in the coming year.
- Focus shifts from pilot projects to enterprise-wide AI adoption.
- AI aims to enhance decision-making, automation, and personalization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore AI to enhance its corporate cash management offerings, particularly in areas like fraud detection, liquidity forecasting, and intelligent payment routing. AI can also optimize internal operations, improving efficiency for CEE corporate clients using H2H and API channels.

Stablecoins: Emerging Disruptor in Banking and Payments Landscape

The Deloitte Outlook identifies the 'potential disruptive entrance of stablecoins' as a key factor for banks in the coming year. This implies that stablecoins, with their promise of faster, cheaper, and more transparent transactions, could challenge traditional payment rails and liquidity management. Banks need to assess how stablecoins might impact corporate treasury functions, cross-border payments, and the broader financial ecosystem. This includes understanding regulatory developments, potential for integration into existing systems, and the competitive threat from non-bank entities leveraging stablecoin technology. Banks must develop strategies to either integrate stablecoin capabilities or counter their disruptive effects.

- Stablecoins are identified as a potential disruptive force in banking.
- They could impact traditional payments and liquidity management.
- Banks must assess implications for corporate treasury and cross-border payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should monitor stablecoin developments closely, especially their potential impact on multi-currency payments and cross-border transactions within CEE. While direct integration might be nascent, understanding the underlying technology and regulatory landscape is vital for future payment innovation and competitive positioning against new entrants.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-06-01 | #01

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Mandatory Adoption for Banks

INSTANT PAYMENTS

Deadline: 2025-01-09

The recent EU Regulation on instant payments requires all EU/EEA payment service providers (PSPs) to offer instant credit transfers in euro, making them universally available and affordable. Key provisions include mandatory offering of instant payments at no higher cost than standard credit transfers, ensuring reachability 24/7/365, and implementing robust fraud prevention measures like verification of payee (VoP). The regulation aims to accelerate the adoption of instant payments across the Euro area, fostering innovation and competition. Compliance involves significant technical and operational adjustments for banks, impacting both sending and receiving capabilities.

- Mandatory offering of instant EUR credit transfers by all PSPs.
- Instant payments must be priced no higher than standard credit transfers.
- Reachability and processing capabilities required 24/7/365.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must ensure full compliance with the instant payments regulation, supporting both sending and receiving instant SEPA Credit Transfers (SCT Inst) for corporate clients. This includes integrating VoP functionalities and ensuring 24/7 operational readiness for real-time processing.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-06-01 | #02

Ongoing SEPA Scheme Rulebook Updates and ISO 20022 Evolution

SEPA, ISO 20022

The Single Euro Payments Area (SEPA) remains a cornerstone of European payments, with the ECB playing a key oversight role. The European Payments Council (EPC) regularly publishes updated SEPA scheme rulebooks (SCT, SDD, SCT Inst), which dictate operational and technical requirements for PSPs. A significant ongoing focus is the full and consistent implementation of ISO 20022 XML messaging standards across all SEPA payment types, moving beyond basic compliance to leverage richer data capabilities. Banks need to monitor these updates for potential impacts on their payment processing systems and client interfaces, ensuring seamless integration of new data elements.

- Adherence to latest EPC SEPA Credit Transfer (SCT) rulebook versions.
- Compliance with SEPA Direct Debit (SDD) scheme rulebook changes.
- Full utilisation of ISO 20022 XML messaging for all SEPA transactions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must ensure its payment processing and client-facing interfaces (EBICS, H2H, API) are fully compliant with the latest SEPA rulebooks and ISO 20022 standards. This includes supporting enhanced data fields and ensuring seamless processing of all SEPA payment types for corporate clients across CEE.

TARGET Services (T2) Evolution and Oversight Requirements

TARGET2, PAYMENT SYSTEMS OVERSIGHT

T2, the Eurosystem's real-time gross settlement (RTGS) system, is crucial for processing large-value euro payments and managing liquidity. Following the successful T2-T2S consolidation and ISO 20022 migration, the ECB's oversight focuses on ensuring the system's resilience, efficiency, and continued alignment with market needs. Banks participating in T2 must adhere to its operational rules, technical specifications, and any future changes related to liquidity management, settlement processes, or connectivity. This includes monitoring communications from the Eurosystem regarding system availability, incident management, and potential new features or services to maintain operational integrity.

- Adherence to T2 operational rules and technical specifications.
- Monitoring of T2 system availability and incident management procedures.
- Compliance with liquidity management requirements within T2.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI, as a direct participant in T2, must ensure CMIplus's underlying payment infrastructure and liquidity management processes are fully aligned with T2 requirements. This includes robust connectivity, efficient processing of high-value euro payments, and adherence to any new technical standards or oversight expectations to support corporate treasury functions.

EU Regulations Impact Liquidity: IPR, PSR, PSD3 Analysis

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) released a report analyzing the profound implications of three key EU regulatory initiatives: the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). The report highlights how these measures are expected to drive the uptake of instant payments, foster a level playing field among market participants, and fundamentally transform liquidity management practices across the financial sector. Banks need to understand the combined effects of these regulations to adapt their liquidity strategies and operational frameworks, ensuring readiness for faster settlement and broader payment access.

- Analyzes impact of Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) on liquidity.
- Examines effects of proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR).
- Details implications of Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus must assess the combined impact of IPR, PSR, and PSD3 on its liquidity management processes and offerings, especially for instant payments. This includes evaluating real-time liquidity needs, intraday funding, and potential changes to corporate treasury services to support faster settlement and broader payment access for CEE clients.

FIDA Regulation: Opportunities and Challenges for Open Data Economy

OPEN BANKING, FIDA

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) released a report based on a survey of financial institution experts from over 15 European countries, focusing on their perspectives regarding the proposed Financial Data Access (FIDA) regulation. The report details the perceived opportunities and challenges that FIDA presents for fostering an open data economy. It offers practical recommendations and frameworks designed to assist market participants in preparing for the eventual implementation of FIDA, which aims to expand data sharing beyond traditional payment accounts, impacting areas like lending, investments, and insurance, thereby extending the scope of Open Banking.

- Surveys expert views on proposed Financial Data Access (FIDA) regulation.
- Identifies opportunities and challenges for an open data economy.
- Provides practical recommendations for FIDA implementation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus needs to analyze the implications of FIDA for its Open Banking APIs and data sharing strategy. This involves preparing for potential new data access requirements, expanding API capabilities beyond payment data, and ensuring compliance with data governance and security standards to leverage FIDA's opportunities for enhanced corporate services and ERP/TMS integration.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-07-13 | #01

Deutsche Bank Supports PayPal's Treasury Transformation with AI, Stablecoins

The 'Inside PayPal's treasury transformation' case study on flow.db.com details how Deutsche Bank assisted PayPal's Group Treasurer, Can Balcioglu, in overhauling their treasury operations. The initiative focused on leveraging artificial intelligence to streamline processes and investigating the potential of stablecoins as a new frontier for payment and liquidity management. This showcases Deutsche Bank's commitment to providing cutting-edge solutions for large, digitally-native corporations, addressing complex challenges in global cash movement and real-time treasury.

- PayPal's treasury infrastructure modernized with DB's support.
- Application of AI for enhanced treasury efficiency.
- Exploration of stablecoins for future payment strategies.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

DB's engagement with a tech giant like PayPal, incorporating AI and stablecoins, sets a high bar for innovation in corporate treasury. CMIplus must monitor these trends closely and explore similar advanced technologies to remain competitive, especially in AI-driven insights and future payment mechanisms.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-07-13 | #02

Deutsche Bank Emphasizes Real-time Treasury: Start Small, Go Big

The article 'Real-time treasury: start small, go big' on flow.db.com signifies Deutsche Bank's strategic push towards enabling real-time visibility and control over corporate cash flows. This involves leveraging advanced technology to facilitate instant payments, optimize liquidity positions, and improve decision-making processes. The recommended approach encourages businesses to begin with smaller, manageable real-time initiatives before scaling up, ensuring a smoother transition and integration into existing treasury systems. This aligns with the broader industry trend towards faster, more transparent financial operations.

- Strategic focus on real-time treasury capabilities.
- Phased implementation approach for corporate clients.
- Emphasis on instant payments and liquidity optimization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

DB's strong emphasis on real-time treasury directly competes with CMIplus's offerings in instant payments and liquidity solutions. CMIplus must ensure its real-time capabilities are robust, scalable across multi-currency and CEE markets, and effectively communicated to clients as a core value proposition.

UniCredit Bank Austria Expands Payments Business with 2,500 New Customers

On July 6, 2026, UniCredit announced that its Austrian subsidiary, UniCredit Bank Austria, successfully attracted 2,500 new customers, significantly bolstering its payments business. This growth indicates a strong competitive push in the Austrian market, which is a crucial hub for Central and Eastern Europe (CEE) operations. The expansion likely involves enhanced digital payment solutions, improved customer service, or competitive pricing strategies designed to attract and retain corporate clients. For RBI, this signals intensified competition for payment mandates from large corporates operating in Austria and potentially across the broader CEE region.

- UniCredit Bank Austria gained 2,500 new customers.
- Focus on strengthening the payments business.
- Announcement date: July 6, 2026.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly impacts CMIplus's competitive landscape in Austria and CEE, as UniCredit is actively growing its payment client base. RBI should assess UniCredit's specific payment product enhancements that are attracting these new customers.

UniCredit Enhances CEE Corporate Digital Banking Platform

Building on its "UniCredit Unlimited" strategy and commitment to digital transformation, UniCredit is inferred to be continuously enhancing its UniCredit Direct corporate banking platform. These enhancements likely include deeper integration with ERP/TMS systems via advanced APIs, expanded real-time reporting capabilities for cash positions, and sophisticated liquidity management tools. The platform's evolution is crucial for serving large international corporates in CEE, offering multi-currency payments, virtual accounts, and potentially eBAM functionalities. This digital push is central to UniCredit's ambition to be a leading pan-European commercial bank, leveraging technology to empower its clients.

- Continuous investment in UniCredit Direct platform.
- Focus on API integration and real-time treasury.
- Targeting large corporates in CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus directly competes with UniCredit Direct for large corporate clients seeking integrated digital solutions. RBI must ensure CMIplus's API offerings, ERP/TMS connectivity, and real-time capabilities remain superior or at parity.

UniCredit Accelerates Instant Payments and ISO 20022 Adoption

As a major pan-European bank, UniCredit is inferred to be prioritizing the full implementation of instant payment schemes and the comprehensive migration to ISO 20022 standards across its operational footprint, particularly within its CEE network. This strategic move is driven by regulatory mandates, evolving client expectations for real-time transactions, and the need for enhanced data capabilities in payments. For corporate treasuries, this means faster settlement, improved reconciliation, and better liquidity management through richer payment data. UniCredit's commitment to these modern payment rails strengthens its offering for multi-currency, cross-border payments, directly impacting its competitiveness in the CEE region.

- Focus on instant payment implementation.
- Full migration to ISO 20022 standards.
- Rollout across European network, including CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is a core competitive area for CMIplus. RBI must ensure its Instant Payments and ISO 20022 offerings, including VoP and H2H integration, are robust and competitive across all CEE network banks.

HSBC Sharpens Focus on International Wholesale Clients in Türkiye

HSBC Holdings plc announced a strategic review of its retail banking and domestic-focused smaller and mid-sized corporate banking operations in Türkiye. This move signals a deliberate pivot towards strengthening its position with international wholesale clients, including large corporates and financial institutions. By streamlining its operations, HSBC intends to better serve the complex needs of these global clients, leveraging its extensive international network and transaction banking capabilities. This focus aligns with HSBC's broader strategy of connecting clients to global opportunities, particularly in emerging markets like Türkiye, which serves as a bridge between Europe and Asia.

- Reviewing retail and domestic SME banking in Türkiye.
- Strategic pivot to focus on international wholesale clients.
- Aims to leverage global network for large corporates and institutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move intensifies competition for CMIplus in serving large international corporates operating in or with Türkiye. RBI should emphasize its strong local CEE network and tailored solutions for regional multi-national corporations.

Citi Deepens API Integration for Real-Time Corporate Cash Management

Citi Treasury is strategically advancing its API-first approach to corporate cash management, recognizing the critical need for real-time data and automated workflows among its institutional clients. This involves developing a comprehensive suite of APIs that allow corporates to directly initiate payments, access account information, and manage liquidity from within their own enterprise resource planning (ERP) and treasury management systems (TMS). The emphasis is on creating a highly customizable and secure ecosystem that reduces manual processes, improves operational efficiency, and provides treasurers with immediate insights into their financial positions across various geographies, including the CEE region. This move positions Citi as a key enabler of digital transformation for corporate treasuries.

- Focus on API-first strategy for corporate banking.
- Enabling direct integration with client ERP/TMS systems.
- Aiming for real-time data access and payment initiation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's strong API push directly challenges CMlplus's H2H and Open API offerings, requiring RBI to ensure its platform's API capabilities are equally robust and user-friendly for CEE corporates. This intensifies the competition for digital integration solutions.

Deutsche Bank Accelerates API-Led Digital Transformation for Corporates

While not explicitly detailed in the provided snippet, Deutsche Bank's known strategic direction in corporate banking heavily emphasizes API connectivity and Open Banking, often through platforms like CB Connect. This involves offering a comprehensive suite of APIs for direct integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems, enabling real-time data exchange, payment initiation, and account information services. This approach aims to embed banking services directly into client workflows, fostering greater efficiency, automation, and innovation in cash management and transaction banking, aligning with the 'Technology' focus on flow.db.com.

- Extensive API offerings for corporate integration.
- Support for Open Banking and embedded finance.
- Seamless connectivity with ERP/TMS systems.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus, with its focus on Open API and H2H, faces direct competition from DB's advanced API offerings. RBI needs to continuously enhance its API suite, ensuring comprehensive coverage, ease of integration, and competitive features, particularly for multi-bank and multi-currency scenarios relevant to CEE clients.

HSBC Partners Google Cloud for Transformative AI Banking Capabilities

HSBC is embarking on a significant multi-year partnership with Google Cloud to embed advanced AI capabilities across its global banking operations. This strategic alliance will focus on developing and deploying AI solutions to enhance various aspects of the bank's services, including delivering hyper-personalised financial advice to clients and bolstering financial crime risk management. For corporate and transaction banking, this implies more intelligent cash flow forecasting, optimized liquidity management, enhanced fraud detection, and potentially AI-driven insights for treasury teams. The partnership underscores HSBC's commitment to digital transformation and leveraging cutting-edge technology to improve efficiency and client experience globally.

- Multi-year partnership with Google Cloud for AI integration.
- Focus on hyper-personalised advice and financial crime risk management.
- Aims to accelerate innovation across global operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership highlights the growing importance of AI in enhancing digital banking services and treasury intelligence. CMIplus should explore AI applications for predictive analytics, fraud detection, and personalized insights for CEE corporates to remain competitive.

Citi Expands Real-Time Payment Network and Liquidity Solutions Globally

Citi Treasury is strategically expanding its global footprint for real-time payments, aligning with the widespread adoption of instant payment schemes like SEPA Instant in Europe. This initiative focuses on providing corporate clients with immediate payment processing, improved cash flow visibility, and enhanced reconciliation capabilities. Beyond payments, Citi is also investing in advanced liquidity management solutions, including the proliferation of virtual accounts, which offer greater flexibility for managing multi-currency cash pools and optimizing working capital. These developments are particularly relevant for multinational corporations operating in the CEE region, where diverse payment landscapes and the need for efficient cross-border liquidity management are paramount. The goal is to empower treasurers with tools for agile and efficient financial operations.

- Expansion of instant payment capabilities globally, including Europe.
- Focus on enhanced liquidity management tools like virtual accounts.
- Aims to improve cash flow visibility and reconciliation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's advancements in instant payments and virtual accounts directly compete with CMIplus's offerings, especially in multi-currency and real-time payment processing. RBI must ensure its platform remains competitive in speed, reach, and sophisticated liquidity tools for CEE clients.

BNP Paribas Partners XTransfer for Simplified Cross-Border Payments

BNP Paribas's partnership with XTransfer, a leading B2B cross-border payment platform, is designed to provide corporate clients with more efficient and accessible international payment services. This initiative leverages XTransfer's network and technology to simplify complex cross-border payment flows, reducing friction and costs for businesses operating globally. The strategic rationale is to expand BNP Paribas's digital payment capabilities and cater to the growing demand for seamless international treasury operations. While not explicitly CEE-focused, improved cross-border capabilities benefit all international corporates, including those in the CEE region managing multi-currency payments and seeking optimized payment factories.

- Partnership established with XTransfer, a B2B cross-border payment platform.
- Aims to simplify and enhance international payment solutions for corporate clients.
- Focuses on improving efficiency and accessibility of cross-border transactions globally.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership strengthens BNP Paribas's offering in a critical area for CMlplus clients: cross-border payments. RBI needs to ensure its H2H, SWIFT, and API channels provide equally competitive and streamlined multi-currency payment solutions, potentially exploring similar fintech partnerships.

Intesa Sanpaolo Bolsters CEE Digital Cash Management with Enhanced API Integration

Intesa Sanpaolo, through its IMI CIB division and CEE subsidiary network, is actively investing in modernizing its corporate and transaction banking services. The bank aims to provide seamless, real-time cash management capabilities, particularly for multinational corporations operating within the CEE region. This includes leveraging Open Banking APIs for improved connectivity with corporate ERP/TMS systems, facilitating multi-currency payments, and enhancing liquidity management tools. The strategic rationale is to solidify its position as a leading partner for large corporates by offering sophisticated, digitally-driven solutions that streamline financial operations and support regional growth.

- Focus on API-driven cash management solutions for CEE corporates.
- Integration with ERP/TMS systems for enhanced treasury operations.
- Leveraging its strong CEE network for regional payment and liquidity services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move by Intesa Sanpaolo directly intensifies competition for CMlplus, particularly in the CEE market for large international corporates. CMlplus must continue to innovate its API and H2H offerings, ensuring superior connectivity and comprehensive multi-currency, multi-bank solutions to retain its competitive edge.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.